



FLOTSAM AND JETSAM

Unfortunately, it is not just floating seaweed that is driven into the Sargasso Sea. The currents also gather up trash that has been thrown from ships or carried down rivers into the ocean. These currents push the trash into the middle of the Sargasso Sea, where it forms a floating garbage dump.



LURKING KILLER

The sargassum fish is a master of disguise. It is adorned with flaps and tassels that look just like seaweed fronds, so it can hide among the floating weed and ambush its prey. It has a huge mouth that allows it to swallow fish almost as big as itself—including other sargassum fish.



SARGASSUM CRAB

Most crabs live on the seabed, but the sargassum swimming crab is adapted for swimming in open water among the floating sargassum weed. The crab's excellent camouflage makes it hard to see among the weed, and enables it to pounce on unwary shrimp, worms, sea slugs, and other small prey.



BABY TURTLES

When north Atlantic loggerhead turtles hatch on tropical beaches, they head for the Sargasso Sea. Here, the young turtles hide among the floating seaweed, safe from their enemies. They feed on small animals living in the weed until they are about 18 in (45 cm) long, then they leave for shallow coastal seas.